

LM Studio Installation Guide

Prerequisites for LLM Practical Sessions

2025-04-30

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Course Prerequisites: Installation of LM Studio

For the hands-on activities in this course, it is essential that you have LM Studio installed on your computer. LM Studio provides an easy-to-use interface to run local large language models (LLMs) without requiring advanced technical skills.

Please follow these instructions carefully.

1. System Requirements

Before installing LM Studio, ensure your machine meets the following minimum requirements:

- **Operating System:** Windows 10/11 (64-bit), macOS 12+, or Linux (Ubuntu 20.04+)
- **RAM:** Minimum 16 GB (32 GB recommended)
- **Disk Space:** At least 20 GB free space
- **GPU (optional):** A dedicated NVIDIA GPU will improve performance but is not mandatory

2. Downloading LM Studio

1. Go to the official website: <https://lmstudio.ai>
2. Click on **Download**
3. Select the appropriate version based on your operating system
4. Save the installer file to your computer

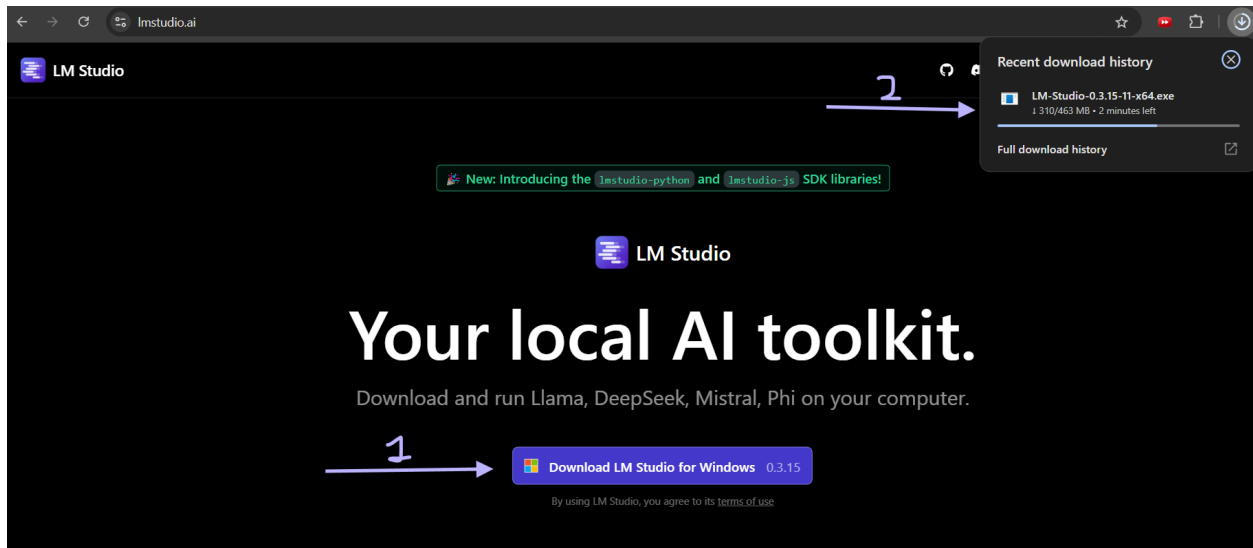


Figure 1: LM Studio Website Homepage

3. Installing LM Studio

On Windows:

1. Double-click the downloaded `.exe` file
2. Approve any security prompts
3. Follow the on-screen setup instructions
4. Complete the installation

On macOS:

1. Open the downloaded `.dmg` file
2. Drag LM Studio into Applications
3. Open from Applications, approve any security prompts

On Linux:

1. Download the `.AppImage` or `.deb` file
2. Use `chmod +x` and run, or `dpkg -i` for installation via terminal

4. First Launch

Open LM Studio after installation. You may need to accept terms of service and allow any initial downloads. No account creation is required.

5. Downloading a Local Model

1. Open LM Studio
2. Go to the **Models** tab
3. Search for and download a model

- You can filter by size, rating, and other parameters
- For beginners, start with a smaller model:
 - Qwen models are available in 8 sizes - you can start with the smallest one (0.6B) which is ~1GB
 - Other good starter models include Phi-2, Mistral 7B, or TinyLlama

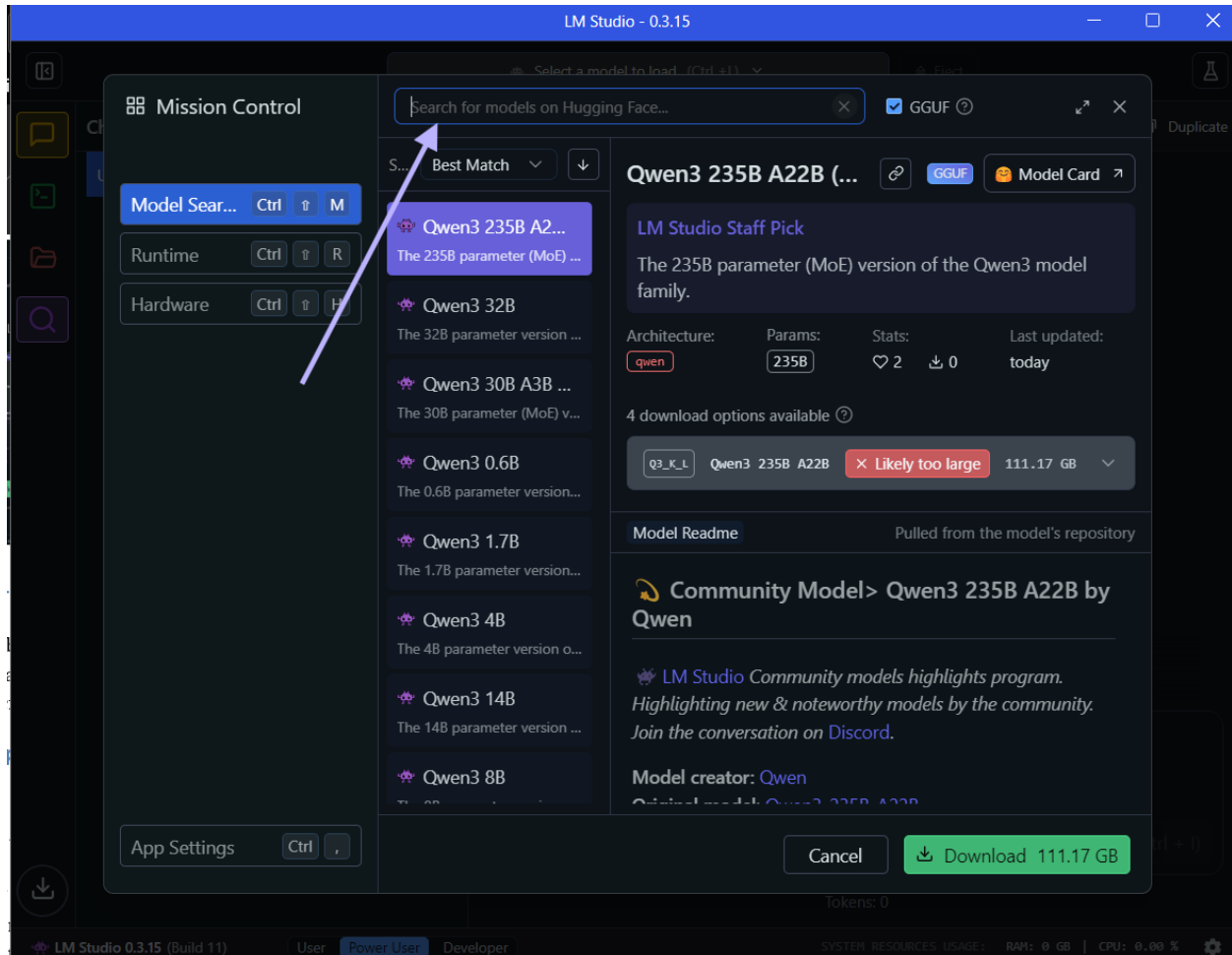


Figure 3: Model Selection Screen

6. Testing the Setup

1. Open the **Chat** tab
2. Select your downloaded model
3. Type a prompt (e.g., “Explain what a complete blood count test shows”)
4. Verify that you receive a coherent response

7. Troubleshooting

- Ensure your system meets the minimum requirements
- Restart your computer after installation
- If you encounter any issues, visit <https://lmstudio.ai/docs> for help

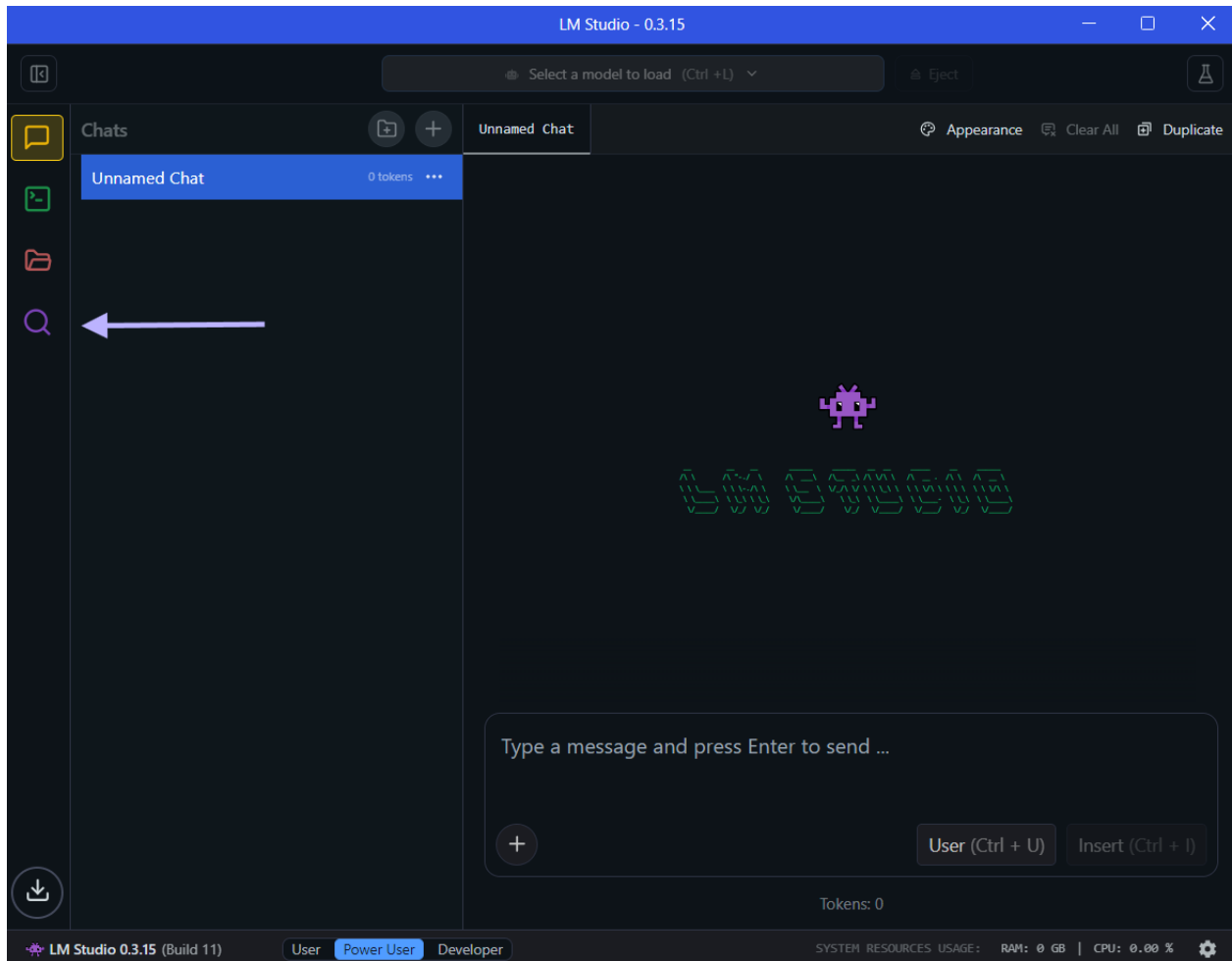


Figure 4: Chat Interface

Notes

- Please bring your laptop with LM Studio pre-installed to class
- If you encounter issues with installation, contact the course instructor before the practical session

Thank you and see you in class!